Heights of High Country (Ashburton Gorge)

Office Hours Rogaine – 7 hour
Saturday 25 November 2006

Dear Team,
Thank you for your entry.

Your team number is:
Please remember it.

As team contact person, please ensure all team members are familiar with all the information below and attached. This information is also accessible at: www.rogaine.org.nz. We hope you enjoy the event.

Getting to the event
REGISTRATION and START/FINISH is at Inverary farm in the Ashburton Gorge between Mt. Somers and the Ashburton Lakes (Heron, Clearwater...) It is a 1 hour 30 min. drive SW of Christchurch (recommend Thompsons Track from Rakaia to Mt Somers). From Mt Somers village drive 10 km up the Ashburton Valley (Ashburton Gorge Road) towards the lakes. The driveway into Inverary is left, 200 m past the turnoff to the Woolshed creek car park for Mt Somers Walkway, marked by an AA sign INVERARY STATION - PRIVATE ROAD. Drive in to the woolshed, 1.5 km and park to the left.

Mt. Somers has good accommodation 10 km from the start - tent sites $10 in the sheltered and attractive domain and cabins of various grades next door at the holiday park.

Registration and start

Registration starts at **7.30 am** from when maps and electronic wrist-tags are issued. Ensure your team is together and that you have your **completed indemnity form** with you. Briefing is at **8.45 am**. Ensure that you register the electronic wrist-tag you have been given on one of the BRIEF punches which will be available at this briefing. The event will start at **9.00 am**. For details on using the Navlight Electronic Scoring System see the homepage of the website www.rogaine.org.nz.

The event will close at **4 pm sharp** at the START/FINISH. If you finish after that you will be penalised 10 points per minute late.

Finish

As soon as you finish, register your wrist-tag on any one of several FINISH Punches, assemble your team, and then present yourselves to the computer desk to have your wrist-tags removed and scored. Wait for an immediate printout of your score. If you have any disagreement with it, see the event organizer, NOT the scoring team. Scores will be notified on the day and published on www.rogaine.org.nz as soon as possible after the event.

Event chronology

7.30 am	REGISTRATION OPENS (Inverary Station)
	Route planning and preparation
8.45	Briefing
9 am	START
4 pm	FINISH
soon after	Results

Mt. Somers Playcentre will provide soup, light BBQ, and a hot drink at the woolshed / car park from 4 pm (covered in entry fee).

What to bring

Clothing and safety equipment is listed under ‘Safety Sheet’.

You will also need

- a range of marker pens, pencils and highlighters, pins and string, and ruler, for planning and measuring your route before you start
- eating utensils for the meal after the event (cutlery, plate(s), mug)
- camp stools and table for route planning (optional)

A clear resealable plastic bag will be provided by the organisers for each map.

Navigation devices such as GPS or altimeter, including watches with altimeters, are **not allowed**.

Food and drink.

Carry enough for a long day in the field. You may return to the start-finish at any time for a rest, or a drink. There will be a water drop towards the centre of the map, and marked on the map. We judge it to be safe to draw drinking water from the larger streams, especially those ‘out the back’, at your discretion.

Your back country travel skills.

If your team lacks confidence in finding its way in moderate, untracked tramping terrain, or if weather conditions are poor, we suggest you confine your route to the more easily accessible check points.

Cancellation

This event will only be cancelled if conditions are extreme; to be notified at the start. The organisers reserve the right to shorten the event for safety or other reasons.

Registration and event procedure

At the registration desk your team must present the completed Indemnity and Emergency Contact Form. Ensure you have entered your team number on the form. You will then be issued with:

- one event map (1:50,000 scale topo. map) and checkpoint description sheet per team member, and zip-loc plastic bag.
- a single black/white version of the map to be used as your “flight plan”. Enter your team number and plot your intended route on this map, including direction of travel, and return it to registration before you start. (You may subsequently modify your route according to conditions as you progress).
- An electronic wrist-tag for each competitor, or two per team, (TBC). This MUST be worn on the wrist with the security band provided.

We recommend you spend at least 45 minutes planning your route, making the day more enjoyable and rewarding. You should plan your route carefully, aiming to challenge your map reading and navigation skills but to stay within the safe limits set by the terrain and weather, your experience and fitness.

Your team may visit any number of check points and in any order. Your aim is to maximise your ‘score’. There are (about) 34 checkpoints, each with a unique number. The score value is the first digit followed by a zero. Thus checkpoint number 23 has a score of 20 points and 91 a score of 90.

All members of your team must attend the event briefing. Each person must register their Tag on one of the BRIEF Punches as you enter the briefing area. All teams start together. Concentrate on your own team plan; do not try to follow other teams.

Each checkpoint comprises an orange/white flag on a stake or tied to a bush or post etc., and an electronic punch. As they have been placed in the field up to a week before the event we cannot be certain that all are still intact. If a checkpoint is missing, you must be able to describe its presumed original location to the score keepers to be credited with the points.

When you visit a checkpoint, EACH COMPETITOR must place the Punch in their wrist-tag until a red flashing light is seen. (Less than 3 seconds, and probably half a second.). If the punch doesn't flash, write down the 3-letter code visible inside it. (See the top of the homepage of the website www.rogaine.org.nz to access further details on 'NAVLIGHT').

A full set of rules governing rogaining in New Zealand is available on www.rogaine.org.nz.

Safety Sheet - Heights of High Country
Office Hours Rogaine - 7 hr.
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Compulsory clothes and equipment per team member:

thermal top & trousers	thermal hat and gloves
shower proof/windproof coat	survival sheet or pack liner
whistle	pencil or fine spirit marker per team
food, water bottle	first aid kit per team
at least one compass per team	

suitable, robust, well-fitting footwear with well-treaded soles.

Your gear is your own responsibility. There will be no compulsory gear check but the organisers reserve the right to do checks on a random or selective basis. You must be suitably equipped to start.

We **strongly recommend** you also carry:

fully rainproof parka, second layer thermal top, long gaiters, showerproof over trousers, a compass each, watch. You may wish to use walking poles.

Cell phone coverage is limited to some high points, but worth taking a phone per team. We will provide a base number on the day.

Safety is a top priority during this event. Organisers and participants (you) have responsibilities for safety. Your responsibilities include:

- being aware of and meeting all safety requirements specified by event organisers in writing, on the event web site, or verbal briefings,
- carrying all compulsory protective clothing and other safety equipment,
- advising your team member(s) of any medical conditions you have, your general level of fitness and other factors that may affect you adversely during the event,
- staying together as a team at all times, and providing mutual support, and helping any other team you find in difficulties,
- depositing a 'flight plan' map showing your intended course at registration before you start,
- recording each person's visit to a checkpoint with the electronic punch,
- advising organisers, and returning your tags, if you withdraw from the event, or when you finish. This is our safety check that you are no longer on the course and **IS COMPULSORY,**
- being highly conscious of time and avoiding a late return – being late results in a hefty points penalty as well as raising safety concerns,
- being prepared to modify your plans to be more conservative if safety conditions dictate this,
- monitoring team and individual progress and fitness and modifying plans as required,
- looking out for hazards, such as:

1. **Hypothermia.** Wind, water and cold temperatures can lead to exposure or hypothermia. Early symptoms are subtle (clumsiness, lethargy, slurred speech). Be prepared to seek shelter or to call it a day if conditions are severe, or if any of your team is becoming exhausted. In severe weather, keep off high, exposed ridges.
2. **Dehydration.** Drink lots of water – we suggest you carry at least 2 litres per person. Water in streams and bottled at a point near the centre of the map.
3. **Streams**. Do not cross streams if they are heavily swollen.

4. **Rock bluffs, slippery rocks, loose rocks, incised creeks, gullies, slippery grass, hidden obstacles such as loose fencing wire**, etc. may be present throughout the event area.
5. **Fog/low cloud**. If in fog, orientate the map and yourself with a compass. If in doubt, don't climb into cloud, and descend out of it as soon as possible.
6. **Hunters**: We cannot absolutely guarantee that hunters will not be present in the area. We recommend you keep highly visible, and heard, if you are concerned.
7. **Deer fences**. Do not cross <u>any</u> deer fences into neighbouring properties, which are out of bounds.
8. **Electric fences**. Look for insulators on the post. Treat all electric fences as ON. Climb through non-live wires, or use parka, pack or map for insulation.

In the event of serious injury or exhaustion, make the injured person warm and comfortable; arrange, if possible, to leave someone with the person; note your exact location on the map; seek help via the nearest road. Emergency signal: repeated (6 or more) short blasts on whistle at about 1 second intervals, repeated each 1 to 5 minutes. Repeat if you hear one long blast. If you become totally disorientated, travel down slope to sheltered ground.

The hut marked near the centre of the map provides shelter.

IT IS SPRING IN THE HIGH COUNTRY – BE PREPARED

This area can be very exposed to bad weather during nor'westers, southerly fronts, and other conditions which can occur at any time It's been a tough spring so far.

Environmental and farm care

Rogaining is an environmentally and socially friendly activity and we expect you to reinforce this ethic.

- Respect farm stock, fences and other facilities, and the rights of landowners to operate their business and lifestyle.
- **Lambing and calving has only recently finished - give them plenty of space and don't spread out as a team too much. Give the cows and calves an especially wide berth and don't get between mum and baby.**
- **LEAVE GATES AS FOUND.** They will usually be shut. Shut them if you have any doubt.
- Cross fences, where you must, at a strainer post, or climb through.
- Report any damage, or distress to stock etc. to the organisers
- Protect plants and animals
- Remove rubbish – more importantly, don't create it in the first place
- Bury toilet waste - better still, don't create it in the field - use the Portaloos provided at the START/FINISH where possible.
- Keep streams clean

This event is wholly on leased or privately owned land and we gratefully thank John and Anne Chapman and family, *Inverary*, and their neighbours Blair and Sarah Gallagher, *Rangiatea*, who have welcomed us for this event. Please ensure the trust they have placed in us is justified.

BASIC INFORMATION

Rules in brief:

- Use compass and rogaine event map only. GPS and/or altimeter units are not allowed, including watches with altimeters.
- Travel only on foot.
- Team members to stay within verbal contact of each other at all times. **All members** must visit each checkpoint and use the Punch in their wrist tags.
- If a check point is missing, be able to describe the local setting in detail to the organizer at the finish to verify your visit.
- When visiting the START/FINISH, all team members must report to the finish area and register a FINISH punch on their wrist tags. You may still go out again later.
- If a competitor wishes to withdraw, the entire team must return to the START/FINISH and notify the organisers. (Team retains current points score). Teams of one are not permitted.
- Event finishes at 4 pm or as specified at the start.
- When your team finishes, **all** members **must** report to the finish area and register a FINISH punch on their wrist tags. Then immediately report to the scoring table to have your wrist-tags removed and scored.

Procedure at each checkpoint

- All team members must use the electronic Punch to register on their wrist-tags. If a Punch fails to operate record its internal 3-letter code (visible through the clear plastic) to verify your visit, and after you finish and have returned your Tags inform the event organizer.

Points value, penalty points, protests

- Checkpoints 20 to 29 are worth 20 points, 30 to 39 are worth 30 points, etc.
- 10 points penalty for each minute late. 30 minutes late - all points lost

Safety

- Carry and wear suitable clothing and equipment
- Team to remain together at all times
- Be alert to exhaustion, dehydration, sun, and/or hypothermia
- Help other teams having problems
- If your team withdraws from the event you **must report to the organizers at the START/FINISH**. Otherwise you will be reported overdue and a search will be mounted.

Emergencies

- Emergency signal: repeated, short whistle blasts
- Repeat if you hear one long blast

Serious injury

- Make injured person warm and comfortable
- Leave someone with the injured person if there are more than two in the team.
- Note your exact location on map
- Seek help via nearest safe route or road and return to base

Farm/land courtesy

- Keep clear of buildings, machinery
- Out of bounds means OUT OF BOUNDS
- No **rubbish**, no **dogs**, no **fires**, no **firearms,**
- Report any damage, etc. to event organisers

A full set of rules governing rogaining in New Zealand is available on www.rogaine.org.nz

TEAM NUMBER: _____

Heights of High Country - Saturday 25 November 2006

Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following have been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity

We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organizers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves (including vehicles at the event venue) resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining. We understand the safety requirements set out by the organisers.

Name	Signature	Date	Date of birth

Emergency Contact

Your name and Car Registration Number	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition

NOTE:

1. A parent or guardian must sign the indemnity form on behalf of a competitor under the age of 18.
2. Supply the name, address and telephone number of a person to contact in the event of an emergency. This person must not be a competitor in the event.
3. Supply details of any medical conditions or allergies that might be of assistance to First Aid staff in the event of an accident or emergency.